



Going the hybrid cloud way

We sit down with **Seema Kumar**, Country Leader, Developer Ecosystem and Startups India/SA, IBM to learn more about IBM's hybrid cloud platform - IBM Cloud Private.

Mithun Mohandas | mithun@digit.in

d How has the Indian developer scene evolved over the years?

Seema: We work with a lot of startups and business partners, helping them develop and scale up. We have a team made mostly of developer advocates who are all experts in different fields. We cover cloud, AI, cognitive, block-chain and some of the more upcoming technologies. What we've seen is that the industry has shifted in terms of the influence that the developer carries. Gone are the days when the developer is told by the higher-ups as to which platform, language and database they're supposed to use to build their applications. These days it's mostly up

to the developers to decide what to use. You have polyglot programmers and a lot of scripting languages. Hence, we see a lot of decisions are driven by the developers. Which is why the platforms and tools we design are done with the developers in mind so that they can build their software faster and better.

d Coming to IBM Cloud Private, it seems like a hybrid cloud solution. And looking at the competition, everyone has had their hybrid offerings out already. Isn't IBM a bit behind the competition?

Seema: Well not really. If you look at it, then Cloud Private is not the first offering. It's more of a refreshed offering. We've had a lot of rebranding to the cloud portfolio, we've had Bluemix as a brand name. We had Bluemix dedicated

and Bluemix local, which, were in some shape or form, a private cloud system. With the entire rebranding to IBM Cloud Private, the key change that we made is from an architecture level. The entire cloud native architecture which we support, whether you want to Docker, Kubernetes or Cloud Foundry, we aren't restricting you to any one particular technology.

A lot of our existing customer base who are on traditional middleware like Websphere, which has a large install-base, are trying to migrate. We've also made that migration process very seamless. So I wouldn't say it is late. I'd say that it has been there for a while. We've just refreshed it to be more relevant to our large customers who are now ready to move. We see a lot of movement to the cloud from the bottom of the pyramid. Startups are already in the cloud, it's the large banks and the large enterprises who'll take time. And it's not like the competition has made large inroads either. It's about how you make the journey seamless and you need to ensure key sensitive issues such as security and performance. We're ensuring that all of that it being done very well.

d Since you mentioned security, how does IBM Cloud Private compare to the rest of the competition?

Seema: If you look at how the entire cloud architecture, be it private or public, the security aspect is built in end-to-end. So it is not only about infrastructure security. If I'm building an application for example, it can be very vulnerable to a lot of security threats. So application security is something that needs to be designed at the time the application is being developed. We have an offering called Appscan which runs checks and figures out vulnerabilities within your code to allow the coder to plug it themselves. The other thing is IBM QRadar which is a security intelligence portfolio based on predictive security analytics where we are able to detect threats before they even occur. The third aspect is data security. When you are putting your data out there, we have a data security solution on top of what we already have to ensure that the data is protected and only accessed by the right people.

Read more - <http://digit.in/BTJan181> **d**